

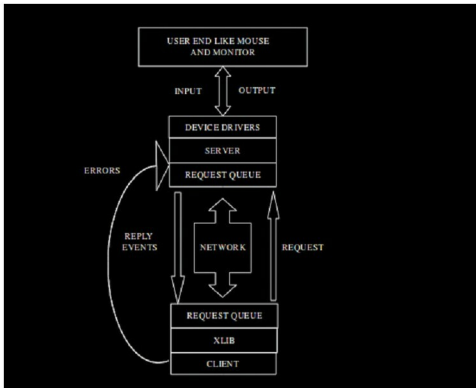


Figure 1: Schematic diagram explaining the working of X

less frequent transfers reduce the overall load. Normally, after an event arrives at a client, the application generates more requests to draw—for example, highlighting the border of a button when the user moves the mouse pointer over it. These responses stay queued in Xlib, until all the events that have already arrived have been processed.

The schematic diagram gives a clear picture about the whole process. When an application starts, all the requests that create the initial appearance (like a splash image) are queued up by Xlib. After the initial loading is done, the application waits for user input from the server. After the user activity is detected, the server sends the requests to Xlib. Please note that the server does not queue or group requests; it acts immediately on any request received from the user or Xlib.

Here, Xlib sends the requests to the client in the order in which they were received. In case there is an error, the application throws an error message to the server, and it generates the necessary output.

What's next?

This article was purely theoretical, and aimed to generate awareness about Xlib. I would personally recommend that you understand all the concepts, to better enable you to write a program in Xlib with a proper flow. This is important, because you have to open and close a connection with the server; understanding the flow lets you know which function to use at which point in time.

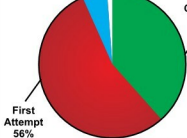
In the next article, I will demonstrate a simple program for plotting a series of points in a graph. The concepts explained in this part will definitely have an impact on your further understanding. See you soon! 

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The author has been using Linux for the past three years, and is a big fan of it. His hobbies are photography and programming. You can contact him at takkalki.amol@gmail.com.


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